Leah Brennan

A small home by 35 and a four-day week

Oct 15, 2026
After session 2, 86% of the picture in

Key numbers

Savings rate	Savings rate with match	Federal tax rate	Left over each month	Net worth	Total debt	Runway	FI number	FI progress	FI date
~29.8% 25.9% to 33.2%	~31.7%	~10.9% marginal 22.0%	~$1,666 a month	$54,840	$12,410	~3 months 4 months at the floor	~$1,296,000 $1,253,427 to $1,338,375	~4.1% of the FI number invested	Feb 2050 age 50, best 47, worst 54

Changes since last time (Sep 17, 2026)

- Savings: balance was $9,800, now $10,200
- Sapphire Preferred: balance was $980, now $640
- Restaurants and takeout: amount was $250 to $350, now $240 to $320

Safe to spend today: $3,268. **Tightest day:** Oct 2026, $3,268.

Decisions on the table: Condo in Oakland ($650 a month more).

Your next wins

- You already have a lean month covered
- You already have a full month covered
- Japan with my sister in Oct 2027
- Full cushion in Feb 2028
- Condo down payment in Jul 2031

Most important to know

- Housing takes about two fifths of take-home
- The 401k match is fully taken; the Roth IRA fills about half of its room
- Cash covers about three months of full spending

What is working

- Four accounts, all with named beneficiaries except the HSA
- Savings land every month without fail

What needs work

- Restaurants and clothing are still rough numbers
- Parking tickets are a $480 a year habit

Do more, do less

More: Keep the Roth transfer automatic; move the gifts line to a known figure after the holidays.
Less: Street parking downtown on Thursdays.

To-dos

Task	Owner	Due
Send the 401k statement	Leah	Oct 20, 2026
Confirm the Sapphire hotel credit posted	Eli	Oct 12, 2026

Real hourly wage $26.52 an hour (your real hourly wage). Biggest expenses in hours a year: housing 20 work-weeks, food 7.1 work-weeks, irregular 2.7 work-weeks. Coverage: 100% of the picture is itemized, 1 of 9 base numbers in.

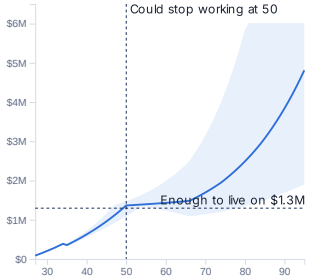
Goals

- Japan with my sister: $6,000 by Oct 2027
- Condo down payment: ~$80,000 by Jun 2035

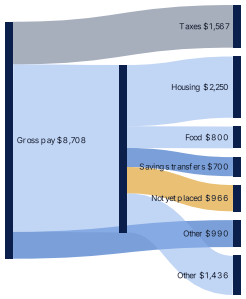
Bring next time

- **California Franchise Tax Board:** CA estimated tax (amount)
- **Direct clients:** Freelance illustration (gross pay)
- **From memory or a statement:** Tutoring, occasional (amount), Restaurants and takeout (amount), Clothing and personal care (amount), Travel (amount) and 3 more
- **Lumen Health:** Product designer (costs of working)
- **Unum:** Long-term disability (coverage)
- **Wells Fargo:** Bilt (credit limit)

What you could have over time



Where the money goes each month



Assumes 5% a year after inflation (3% to 7%), a 4.0% withdrawal rate and Social Security from 67, in today's dollars.